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▲ Parents affected by the childcare benefits scandal for a debate on the case in the House of Representatives. © ANP / ANP

2,090 children removed from home due to childcare benefits scandal, far more than expected

More children of parents who became victims of the childcare benefits scandal have been removed from their homes than previously calculated. According to a new count by Statistics Netherlands (CBS), a total of 2,090 children were removed from their homes in the period from 2015 up to and including June 2022. That is higher than the figure of 1,675 children announced in May.

Tobias den Hartog

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Based on the figures, the organization cannot conclude whether there is a direct link between the out-of-home placement and the childcare benefits scandal. However, in all cases, it concerns children whose parents have been harmed.



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(UHT). Through a recovery scheme, this organization must ensure that children gain access to professional help and a sum of money so that they can get their lives back on track.

The researchers used the list of victims of the UHT as a basis. Subsequently, they examined how many children of aggrieved parties had been removed from their homes. According to Statistics Netherlands (CBS), this does not directly mean that these removals are a consequence of the childcare benefits scandal. This is because the statistics agency did not investigate the causes of the removals, as it does not have access to the underlying files. Furthermore, only removals carried out via a child protection measure pronounced by the court were included. The actual number of children removed from their homes may therefore be even higher.

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Remarkable

Incidentally, Statistics Netherlands (CBS) previously published a [striking finding following research](#). At the beginning of this month, it emerged that children of parents receiving benefits did not run a greater risk of being placed under supervision or guardianship than others. Previously, children of benefit-receiving parents appeared to come to the attention of child protection services sooner, but research showed that parents were already more frequently identified by agencies before they became victims of the affair. The 'state abductions' that were spoken of turned out to be too one-sided a picture; often, there were already significant problems within the families.

Of the 2,090 children who have been placed in out-of-home care since 2015, 645 were still not living with their parents or guardians at the end of June this year. The childcare benefits scandal primarily affected households with a migration background, single-parent families, and low-income families, Statistics Netherlands concluded earlier this year.

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